

The True Cost of Missed Calls

The math nobody runs on an unanswered phone — with typical dollar figures for twelve service industries in Southwest Florida.

Who this is for: owners of service businesses — trades, offices, and agencies — who suspect the phone is leaking revenue but have never put a number on it. Ten minutes with this guide and a calculator will tell you.

The problem you can't see on a P&L

A large share of calls to service businesses ring out during business hours — not at midnight, not on holidays, but while the trucks are out and the office is juggling three things at once. Most callers who hit voicemail don't leave a message. They hang up, scroll to the next name on Google, and call your competitor.

That's the part owners miss. You're not "losing leads" in an abstract funnel. You're handing warm, ready-to-buy customers directly to the business one listing down — after paying for the marketing that made your phone ring in the first place.

Why it happens to well-run shops

It isn't a discipline problem; it's a physics problem. Your best people are on roofs, under sinks, in consults, chairside — exactly where they can't pick up. A second call arrives while the first is still going. Lunch happens. The 7 PM storm-damage call lands after everyone's gone home. The phone is a single point of failure, and humans can't be in two places at once.

Speed decides the winner

When something's broken, customers don't comparison-shop for three days — they call down the list until someone answers, and they usually book the first competent person who does. Research on lead response popularized by the Harvard Business Review / MIT studies found responding within five minutes makes you roughly **21× more likely to qualify the lead** than waiting thirty. After that, the curve falls off a cliff.

Every missed call you recover is usually also a job your competitor didn't get. The math cuts both ways.

The math: three numbers you already know

missed calls per month × close rate × average sale

**revenue walking out the door every
month**

Be honest about the inputs. Count after-hours rings, the second line that went unanswered while the first was busy, the lunchtime voicemails. Use your true average ticket — not your best job, not your worst.

What it looks like in Southwest Florida

Typical figures for twelve industries in the Naples / Fort Myers / Miami market, researched July 2026 from published pricing data. The assumptions are deliberately conservative — most shops miss more calls than this.

Industry	Avg sale	What that is	Missed / mo	Close	Monthly exposure
HVAC	\$8,500	avg A/C system replacement	26	20%	\$44,200
Roofing	\$28,000	avg replacement, hurricane code	13	15%	\$54,600
Plumbing	\$500	blended avg ticket	34	30%	\$5,100
Electrical	\$750	avg residential job	26	30%	\$5,850
Insurance	\$600	first-year commission / policy	34	25%	\$5,100
Real estate	\$13,500	one side of a closing	17	5%	\$11,475
Legal	\$3,500	avg initial retainer	22	15%	\$11,550
Medical / dental	\$1,200	new-patient first-year value	26	35%	\$10,920
Locksmith	\$175	avg service call	43	50%	\$3,763
Property mgmt	\$3,000	annual revenue per door	13	20%	\$7,800
Home services	\$450	blended avg ticket	34	30%	\$4,590
Any service business	\$500	generic avg job value	26	25%	\$3,250

Illustrations, not earnings claims. Average-sale figures come from published Southwest Florida and national pricing sources (contractor pricing guides, Angi/HomeAdvisor data, Redfin market data, FAIA compensation study, industry benchmarks), July 2026. “Missed / mo” assumes 3–10 unanswered calls per week depending on call volume typical for the trade. Your numbers will vary — run your own.

What actually fixes it

The honest options are limited:

A bigger front office is expensive, and still can't cover nights, weekends, or two calls at once.

A traditional answering service picks up, but can't qualify the job, quote a range, or book the appointment — you're still calling everyone back, by which time they've moved on.

An AI voice agent answers on the first ring, every time, around the clock. It qualifies the job, captures the details your team needs, books into your existing scheduler, and texts the customer a confirmation before they've finished their coffee. Twenty simultaneous calls during the first cold snap — no new hires, no busy signal, no voicemail.

The 30-second test

Call your own business right now — once during lunch, once after close. Time how long it rings. Listen to what a customer hears. That experience is your real front door, and it's what this guide just priced.

Hear it answer live

Our AI will actually call you and run the whole flow — qualify, book, confirm — so you can hear it before you decide anything.

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